

ELI DAG Engine — project-wide dependency scheduling

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A single, generic directed-acyclic-graph engine (`eli/core/dag.py`) is now the shared scheduling primitive across ELI: the **agent bus** runs its agents on it, and the **coding engine** runs its subtasks on it. One DAG algorithm, two consumers — no per-subsystem reinvention.

The engine (eli/core/dag.py)

Pure, deterministic, no I/O — fully unit-tested.

- `DAG / DAGNode` — nodes with depends_on edges ($B \text{ depends_on } A \Rightarrow A \rightarrow B$).
- `topological_order()` — Kahn's algorithm, deterministic (sorted ties); raises `DAGCycleError` on a cycle.
- `topological_layers()` — groups nodes into **parallel layers**: layer k holds every node whose dependencies are all in earlier layers. This is what lets independent work run concurrently while dependent work waits.
- `ancestors()` / `descendants()` — transitive closure.
- `critical_path_length()` — longest dependency chain = number of sequential layers (a parallelism metric).
- `build_dag({node: [deps]})` — convenience builder that **drops deps outside the given node set**, so a global dependency map can be applied to any subset safely.

Consumer 1 – the agent bus runs on the DAG (eli/cognition/agent bus.py)

Previously the bus was a single-round star fan-out (agents couldn't use each other's output). Now:

- `_AGENT_DEPENDENCIES` declares edges among agents. Shipped edge: `knowledge_graph ← memory`.
- `_agent_execution_layers(active_names)` builds a DAG from that map n the selected agents and returns topological layers.
- `AgentBus._run_agents_layered` runs **layer by layer**: each layer's agents run in parallel (same per-agent hard timeout + failure handling as before), then every completed layer's results are passed to downstream agents via `intent["_upstream"]`. The `knowledge_graph` agent uses this to seed its lookup with what memory surfaced this turn.
- **Non-regressive**: when no edges apply to the selected set, the DAG collapses to a single layer = the legacy flat fan-out. Gated by `ELI_AGENT_DAG` (default on); any error falls back to flat dispatch (`run_agents_flat`).

```
selected_agents → _agent_execution_layers → [[memory, reflection, ...], [knowledge_graph], ...]
```

Add an edge by editing `AGENT DEPENDENCIES`; cycles are rejected at build time.

Consumer 2 — the coding engine’s subtask DAG (eli/coding/plan_graph.py)

For decomposable coding tasks:

- `decompose_dag(task, generate)` asks the planner for a **graph** of subtasks (`{nodes:[{id, task, depends_on}]}`), builds a DAG, and validates it (cycle/ dangling-edge safe). A cohesive task yields a single node.
- `solve_dag(...)` walks the topological order, solving each node via the normal single-shot tree search and **feeding each node the code of its dependencies**, then `compose()` concatenates the node solutions (imports hoisted/deduped) into one module. `CodeAgent.solve` verifies the composed module against tests synthesized for the *original* task.
- Single-node tasks return `None` so the agent uses the plain single-shot path (no DAG overhead). Gated by `ELI_CODING_DAG` (default on).

Scope & honesty

- **DAG-driven now:** agent-bus execution (topological layers + upstream) and coding subtask decomposition both run on `eli/core/dag`.
- **Still linear (not yet DAG):** the 12-stage orchestrator pipeline is a fixed chain; `execution_planner.ExecutionPlan.steps` is an ordered list. Converting those to DAGs is a possible next step but wasn’t required for “agents on a DAG”.
- **Composition is v1:** the coding DAG composes node code by ordered concatenation with import-deduping; integration quality scales with the model.
- Everything here is covered by `tests/test_dag.py` (engine, layered dispatch via fake agents, coding subtask DAG) — all deterministic.

Control summary

Knob	Default	Effect
<code>ELI_AGENT_DAG</code>	on	agent-bus topological layered dispatch (off ⇒ flat fan-out)
<code>ELI_CODING_DAG</code>	on	coding subtask-DAG decomposition (off ⇒ single-shot only)
<code>_AGENT_DEPENDENCIES</code>	<code>{knowledge_graph: {memory}}</code>	declare agent edges